



TIPS & TRICKS



Switching between multi-tabbed windows

When we open a multi-tabbed window like Firefox or gedit, we use the mouse to switch between multiple panes of this window. In Linux, switching between all multi-tabbed windows can be easily done by using their sequence number with the 'alt' key.

For example, if you have opened multiple tabs in Firefox, Terminal or gedit, you can use `alt+1` to activate the first tab, `alt+4` to activate the fourth tab, and so on.

—Tushar Kute, tushar@tusharkute.com



Moving from the current working directory to the earlier working directory

Let's assume that you are working in a directory (directory-one) and want to move to some other directory (directory-two); you can use the following code for this:

```
[user@host /home/user/directory-one]$ cd ~/projects/  
directory-two
```

With the above command, you will be moved to directory-two. Then when you have to again switch back to your previously working directory, i.e. directory-one, you don't have to write the whole directory's name again, but just enter `cd -` and you will be moved to the previously working directory.

Here's an example:

```
[user@host /home/user/projects/directory-two]$ cd -  
/home/user/directory-one  
[user@host /home/user/directory-one]$
```

—Ankith Herle, ankitherle@gmail.com



Running a recent command with `sudo`

The `sudo` (super user do) command is used to apply or run the administrative Linux command on the terminal. For example, adding users, changing passwords, installing or uninstalling software are all done by the `sudo` command.

Sometimes we forget to write 'sudo' before the actual command. In such cases, we do not need to re-write the whole command, but just type `sudo !!` and the last command will get executed with `sudo`.

Here is an example:

```
$adduser abc
```

This will show a root user error! So type the following, and the same command will get executed with `sudo`.

```
$sudo !!
```

—Tushar Kute, tushar@tusharkute.com



Creating a shortcut to open a terminal window in Debian 8 and 9

In the Debian 8 (Jessie) and Debian 9 (Stretch) versions, there is no default shortcut to open the terminal window — like `Ctrl+Alt+T` in Ubuntu. A custom shortcut has to be created, by doing the following:

1. Open *Settings*.
2. Under the *Hardware* section, click on 'Keyboard'.
3. Scroll down to the *Custom shortcuts* section, and click on the '+' symbol. The *Add Custom Shortcut* dialogue box opens.
4. Name it as *Open Terminal Window*.
5. Give the command as: `gnome-terminal`.
6. In Stretch, the shortcut heading will be present in the *Add Custom Shortcut* box. Enter the shortcut as `Ctrl+Alt+T`, then save and exit.
7. In Jessie, the *Add Custom Shortcut* box closes immediately after entering the command and pressing the *Save* button. The shortcut will be created, but disabled. To enable it, click on the shortcut and type `Ctrl+Alt+T`, and exit.

Now, the shortcut is created, and can be used to open a new terminal session.

—Sangavai Pillai, sangavai@gmail.com

END 

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The joy of using open source software is in finding ways to get around problems—take them head on, defeat them! We invite you to share your tips and tricks with us for publication in *OSFY* so that they can reach a wider audience. Your tips could be related to administration, programming, troubleshooting or general tweaking. Submit them at www.opensourceforu.com. The sender of each published tip will get a T-shirt.